

What you want most

an introduction to Yomonsni
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Introduction

What is it that you want most? What would you do in order to get/achieve it?

Most of us, myself included as I write this, don't really know what we want most. Sure, if you're like me at all, you can very easily identify a lot of things that you want - whether status, fame, accomplishments, wealth, items, relationships, etc. Yet how would you compare a million dollars against a relationship with someone with whom you share an absolute love and trust? Where would you rank the fame of winning a medal at the Olympics against the experience of giving birth?

What is it that you would do to get what you want most? Would you give up refined sugars? Would you limit yourself to six hours of sleep a night and work two full time jobs to save for a house? Would you risk your life savings in the stock market on the chance that you can double your money in a year to be able to spend it all on a house? What would you do, or risk, in pursuit of what you want most? What level of discomfort would you endure along the way?

If you don't know what you want most, if you don't know what you would do to get it, how well do you really know yourself, and how will you ever attain what you want, or recognize if you achieve it?

Really getting to know yourself is one of the core aspects of Yomonsni. Let's step in and take a brief introductory look at the Yomonsni methodology and practice.

What's it all about

Yomonsni is a framework for facilitated personal discovery, growth and development.

I know, that statement sounds like some kind of weird buzzword statement, and buzzwords are seriously something to avoid, so what is it really? Well, let's deconstruct the statement piece by piece, and then try to put it back together.

Yomonsni - a brand new word, since we need something to work with.

Framework - here, framework is a set of tools and methodologies and an approach to take. It is not a 'do x' prescription, but being a framework, it is a scaffolding around which everything can be customized.

Facilitated - You are not alone. There will always be someone to help, to check in with, to talk with on your path. You will have someone who will make your journey and path a little easier, who will at times share the heavy work that will need to be done, and will be there to celebrate your successes with you.

Personal - This is for you. Your journey is your own, who you are, who you will be, where you go, is all uniquely you.

Discovery - most of us really do not know who we are at really deep levels. We accept the surface reflections without ever trying to figure out the real 'why' within us about anything. Why do, or don't, we like pineapple on pizza for example? What does 'success' mean to you - and when you dig into it, what are the pieces of that image that are really yours and not just the societal imposed vision of success?

Growth and Development - Once you have an understanding of yourself from the discovery, where do you want to go? Always in life we are learning and growing until the day we no longer have life. Growth and development is necessary at it's most basic to avoid sitting apathetically on the couch until death claims us, it is how we keep growing, learning and staying active, it is how we enrich our life with experiences. Discovery gives us the understanding of what we want those new experiences to be.... for some, the idea of an experience of jumping out of a perfectly functional airplane is something we want to do, for others, meh.... and for still others, it's an experience we would actively choose to avoid. Discovery lets us understand the difference and to direct our growth.

With that understanding of what the terms mean, the more complex statement might be something like:

Yomonsni is a set of tools, and methodologies, and a pairing of you with someone who will help you, with which you can deeply examine yourself and with which you can face the journey to be and experience what you want in life.

The tools and methodology

Who are you? No, really, who are you when you're alone in the dark?

When you take away the expectations given to you by your family, friends, upbringing, society, and face yourself, naked and alone in the dark, what matters to you in life?

This is not a simple question, and it requires you to understand yourself at fundamental level that many seek to avoid.

How do you get to deep understanding of yourself? Well, it takes work, it takes bravery. Setting aside all expectations, pre-conceptions, values, and beliefs that have been pushed upon you is a big task. The fullness of self-discovery and sense of ownership of having chosen your own values, beliefs, and direction in life, is a reward well worth the effort.

Actually doing this work through Yomonsni is accomplished with a set of tools, some best practices born of experience, and some assistance along the way.

At it's most basic, this effort to self-knowledge requires questions and observations. The best practice here is to use the word, to write. Keep a journal of the questions and answers, observe your feelings on different things in your day, your life, or simply the media you consume. Writing is a powerful tool for introspection, and writing it down can let you set aside the feelings and thoughts rather than keeping them in your mind, distracting you from other activities, including sleep.

Siazul is a Yomonsni word given to the one who facilitates your journey, introspection and development. The don't own your journey, they are not responsible for it, it is yours. They are there though to help, to give you questions, to help your insight, to help keep you accountable to your future self. Part of their responsibility in your journey is to ensure that you are not alone. The core of their interaction with you is through the Yomonsni Massage (much more about that later), but they are available to you for advice and guidance whenever you need (within constraints of having things going on in their own life as well).

Your siazul (not capitalized as you are more important in this process than they are) will help you with questions, and in digging into your answers and reflections to find with you both the insights and patterns present, as well as where you need to dig deeper into the process to get there. This requires them to have access to your innermost self and to your journal.

As you get to know yourself, and what you want in your health, life, knowledge, and growth, the next phase of Yomonsni is a cycle of nourishment, challenge, and recovery. Each of part of this cycle needs to be applied to your Yom (body), Ons (mind), Sni (self). You aren't seeking a perfectly even split between these things, or between the aspects within yourself. An aspiring Olympic athlete will naturally expend more effort in their Yom, but even they need to be whole and consider their Ons and Sni to bring their complete being into their competition and performance. So too does an aspiring Nobel laureate benefit from development of their Yom and Sni to enhance

their Ons.

The overlap between aspects and around the cycle can lead to ambiguity in how activities are tracked, and we'll talk more about that later.

These ideas form the core framework of self-discovery and development within Yomonsni, though there are a great many layers to the implementation.

Within Yomonsni there is no attempt to tell you what or how to think, what you should want in life, what values you should hold or why. These are yours to discover and choose, and the consequences of those choices are yours to carry. Your siazul will help you explore all of these areas and more, and will do their best to give you insight to the consequences of the choices.

Time

Time is our most precious resource. Once gone, we can never get it back. Spending time is often done without thought, and how many of us have ever just wasted time?

We are not bringing this up now to focus on time management, rather this is just ensuring that you spend your time in the balance between what you want most and what you want now that will really make you the happiest in the long term. "Discipline is the ability to choose what you want most over what you want now."

The primary cost of your growth is your time. The time it takes to get to know yourself and what you want, the time it takes to implement the plan to nourish, challenge and recover all aspects of yourself.

This is not to say that your every hour must be consumed by these things, though if your goals are big, that may be the case. Rather it is to put into your awareness early that the things you want will require your time to achieve.

It is more important for you to do something each day, even if you can't put 30 minutes into an improvement task, it's ok if you can make 5 minutes. Even 5 minutes spent right can help you move forward, so don't be afraid of not having enough time to finish. A few minutes can help you think of a plan, they can let you move enough to get your heartbeat up, they can let you outline a sketch. Creativity often explodes when you have constraints placed on you, like only a few minutes available, let your creativity give you possibilities. To get you started, only a few moments at a time is a great opportunity to simply practice mindfulness, whether examining the moment in your body, your mind, your emotional/creative self, or the nuances of the world around you.

Cycles

We talked briefly earlier of the core cycle of Yomonsni, and in many ways, of life itself.

Nourish -> Challenge/Use -> Recover, and back to Nourish again.

Doing this in each part of your integrated self, so emphasis on each Yom, Ons and Sni.

Nourish

Nourishing is the way in which we feed, support and encourage these primary components of our makeup.

As we nourish our Yom, we think most easily about the material food and drink that we consume, but part of it is also the when of the consumption. If you have tea or coffee around the time of eating iron rich plants (like spinach), you will block the absorption of the iron into your body. Separate the two events and you get the iron benefit from the spinach. This interaction doesn't impact the iron in animal sources. You also nourish with sleep, rest, and this is one of the more complicated overlaps, because sleep is also recovery.

As we nourish our Ons, we begin to see some of the overlap and ambiguity in these categories. Watching a lecture, or reading a science book is one way to nourish your Ons, but so is consuming caffeine, or doing good aerobic exercise. Timing here is also something to understand against your own patterns - consumption of food and drink, and supplements, when you exercise, and sleep, and even what else is happening at the time you undertake your learning will all impact and interact with your ability there.

As we nourish our Sni, we think about time in nature, closeness with pets and others, reading fiction, and time listening to music and even watching some kinds of programming.

Challenge / Use

Challenging and Using our primary components is about pushing to various degrees. If we do not push, we can not grow. "Growth happens at the end of comfort." Of course, it is the right discomfort that we are looking for.

Challenging and using our Yom has different loci - Flexibility and Balance, Endurance, Intensity - strength and speed. Using your Yom in each of these ways, pushing yourself in these ways extends your capability, improves your health, makes you happier by releasing endorphins, and increases brain activity by delivering more oxygenated blood to it. So, using our Yom also nourishes our Ons and Sni.

Challenging and using our Ons has some overlap with nourishing it - learning extends our ability to think. Beyond learning though is the application of our knowledge - solving problems, developing new science and technology. You can even solve problems to allow your Sni to be challenged and used, or to learn/discover new

exercises and ways in which to nourish or challenge your Yom.

Challenging and using our Sni has overlap with nourishing our Ons and Yom. We are more capable of exertion if we are in an emotional state to exert. We use our Sni when we create, love, interact with others, take pleasure in our bodies, our senses and the world around us. We share pleasure with each other.

Recovery

Recovery is the down time, the relaxation after the effort, that enables the repair and regeneration of ourselves, and that balances the use and challenge aspect. Without the down time, we don't get that chance to integrate the learning, or to examine our feelings.

Recovery of Yom can be as simple as sleep, but can overlap into things like meditation, and even yoga and different movement based activities. A good shower, or bath, a heating pad or sauna may also fit in here. Rest, heat, gentle movement all can fit in here and promote recovery.

Recovery of Ons can be more interesting, meditation focused on free thought, writing creatively, playing games can all help.

Recovery of Sni starts with time alone, letting the emptiness itself facilitate an emotional and connective grounding back to nothing.

Intention and recognition and your own scales

In order to track these cycles we will use tokens for each phase and each aspect of our total self. If you do 30 minutes of rowing, you can earn yourself a Yom use token. If you spend an hour drawing flowers, you can earn yourself a Sni use token. Where there is overlap between activities and how you many apply them within the cycle, which token you earn is more about the intention you had with the activity. If you do gentle yoga after an hour of running, is it about recovering or challenging your Yom, or is it more about giving yourself an opportunity to meditate in motion and stretch which will help you recover into your Ons? Collect the token that most aligns with your attention.

Recognizing the activities within the cycle can have a few purposes for us. It is a way to record and keep track of the things we do for our development. Each token is also a bit of a reward for us, the recognition of a accomplishment no matter how small. It is a personal currency for us to use with ourselves and our siazul with which we can give ourselves indulgent rewards.

What it takes to earn each token is something for you to decide with your siazul, and it will vary with your development. If you are starting to challenge your Yom after years of simply existing in near completely sedentary lifestyle for example, you may earn a token for something like 10 minutes of exercise, while if you are already a gym junkie, the same single token may be more appropriate after an hour or more, or only if you have upped your intensity within the workout. Earning a token should be done for

things that are exceeding your usual pattern of life.

Indulge

So, what do you do with all of these tokens? Reward yourself.

Again this is nuanced, as taking the pleasure of a warm chocolate chip cookie can be a bit of a way to challenge to your Sni, if you do so fully present and mindful of the sensory experience, or it can be something as a nourish your body if you are working heavily into endurance and need the consumption of calories. So your intention is part of how you classify such an experience.

The indulgence experience and cost in your earned tokens again is fluid and up to you and your siazul. The indulgence is a 'what you want now', and the tokens represent your progress towards 'what you want most', so keeping that in mind, we don't want the indulgences along the way to prevent us from accomplishing what we want most.

Consistency

We want to think about routines in our life. Habits are things we can do without thinking, routines are things we do with thinking and awareness. The distinction is important, because we want to live our lives with intent, so the emptiness of a habit is something to avoid. Habits also are not resilient to interruption, if you get distracted while carrying out a habit, it will often fail in a weird way... did you remember to brush your teeth after the phone call broke your morning's bathroom habits? A routine, working from your active thought is much more resilient to interruption, to changing circumstances or location. If your routine each day includes exercise, you can easily find a way to do it whether trapped in quarantine somewhere, or staying with your family on vacation.

Consistency of practice lets us feel as though we are always making progress. When we lose the consistency of practice, regaining it feels almost like starting again after a failure. So it is quite important to do something little each day to keep that feeling of consistency - even if what you do feels almost trivial compared to your goals.

Daily routines

Each morning, write three goals for the day

These daily goals are things above and beyond what you otherwise have to do. You have to work, fix meals, take care of the kids, pay your taxes, and all the other communities of life, so claiming these as goals does you a disservice. Rather, goals should be things that advance your desires, that get you closer to what you most want.

Daily goals should be things that are small and accomplish-able, there is no point each morning saying "I'm going to find the cure for cancer today", as that is not something that can be accomplished in a day. Your goals should also not involve other people, but should be focused only on you. You should phrase them as an "if/when" "then" format, setting the condition for you to achieve them as you set them.

A poor goal phrasing might be:

Today I will not eat any chocolate.

A better goal phrasing could be:

When I feel a desire to eat chocolate today, instead I will eat an apple.

Each evening, assess yourself against those goals

When you assess yourself, it is not in a success or failure kind of mode. Goals are not always achieved, no matter how small they are. Reflecting on your day against your goals, ask yourself these questions:

What went to plan, what didn't... and why?

If you knew at the end of the day what you knew at the beginning, how would you

have changed your goals?

Which goal achieved made you happiest with the day? Which goal missed do you most wish you could have accomplished?

What tokens do you think you earned, or spent in the day?

Last thing you do before sleeping, think about three things from the day that had a positive impact on you

No matter how bad the day, there is always positive within it. Learning about your ability to survive the horrific events of the day is the absolute worst case positive. Was there a moment in the day where you let go to just smile at the way light reflected in a puddle, or a nuance of how a meal tasted, or a small triumph in a response to a work email. No matter how small, you can find these three things, and just allowing yourself to appreciate them will enable you sleep you more peacefully and deeply.

Somewhere in the day, write your journal

Set yourself a time each day to write your journal. Be consistent about this practice. Ask questions about yourself - either from the day, or more broadly... analyze your desires and the things you want to avoid. Reflect on what about them you want or don't.

The process of learning yourself is a key to growth. The journal is written for you, and should be absolutely uncensored and honest. Observe and reflect how the timing of cycles impacts you, how what you eat/drink impacts your feelings and moods, how things which you learn, or create show you new things about yourself.

Mechanically, you can always get started by writing down the goal/token assessment, and then letting your writing branch out from there.

Siazul pairing

In a well ordered society, the individual is never left alone or uncared for. While the direction and nature of your own growth and development is uniquely yours, it is not something that Yomonsni asks you to do alone. Rather, you are given a dedicated facilitator for your journey.

Every step of the way, your siazul will be there for you, listening, encouraging, and assisting in your chosen direction. With this dynamic, you will always have someone with whom to share your struggles, your half formed thoughts, your challenges, and who will be there to give you the support and encouragement you need in the most difficult moments of your growth. They will help you analyze and assess your goals and drill down into them in order to figure out what you really want. They will help you determine the right questions to ask yourself, and will be there to help investigate the full depth and meaning of your answers. The openness and intimacy between you and your siazul, enhanced and refreshed with the Yomonsni massage experience, is required so that you are comfortable sharing everything freely and without restriction.

Everyone practicing Yomonsni has this relationship dynamic, and every siazul is Jassia to another siazul as well. This is the Yomonsni way to ensure that everyone is treated equally, and must work to get deeper into themselves and keep growing.

In an ideal world, on your entry to Yomonsni, you would take a personality and values test and be matched with a local siazul who best aligns with your personality and values. Yomonsni isn't to that point yet though, so your first session will be something of a mutual interview with a local siazul through a Yomonsni massage experience. Your Yomonsni journey can only continue at this time if this first session can establish a strong open connection for both of you.

The Yomonsni Massage

The development of the entire Yomonsni framework started with the massage. There is a lot of science out there on touch and the physiological and psychological ways in which it creates and facilitates openness, trust, and bonding. Even the touch of a hairdresser has an effect, and hairdressers often end up overwhelmed by the emotional sharing of their clients, which is not at all what they realized they signed up for. [1,2] With a massage, this goes much deeper as the touch is much more intimate. Psychological congruence gives a strong tendency for us to respond to physical touch with feelings of closeness, attraction and intimacy - after all, we only let those we feel that way about touch us in that way. Add in the relaxation of a wonderful massage and mental and emotional barriers come falling down easily, just from the physical aspects. Now, what if there were a good way to also provide a mental and emotional relaxation and restoration as well?

From this background, the Yomonsni Massage experience was born. Conceived as a way to relax and open every part of 'you', and to use that open relaxation to deliver an external insight into your growth and development.

The Yomonsni massage experience is designed to be a pleasurable indulgence and reward to all of you, Yom, Ons and Sni. This experience is part of your journey. Within the massage, touch enhances bonding, intimacy and openness, which are all fundamental components in the Jassia-siazul pairing. These things help you to be open and honest with your siazul, the more you can share honestly, the more they can help you dig in and examine what you want and what you are doing to get there. The more you able to trust your siazul, the more easily you can trust their advice and insight to help you in your efforts.

Wrapping it all up

Yomonsni can not tell you who you are, or what you want. Applied consistently however, Yomonsni will definitely help you discover who you are, and what you want. Even more, it will help you to achieve and attain it.

"This above all else, to thine own self be true."

Recommended reading

Yomonsni is not dogmatic, rather it borrows knowledge, ideas and techniques from wherever it can, and so evolves.

All knowledge is good to have, even if it is not always directly applicable, for often knowledge really only applies when it connects with something else to provide insight.

Below are some writings which will you may find to provide a helpful, deeper, explanation of some of the brief outline above.

Reading on writing:

[The Power of Writing it Down](#) Allison Fallon

Reading on mindfulness:

References

1 - <https://www.abc.net.au/everyday/emotional-labour-in-jobs-like-hairdressing/11586856>

2 - <https://escholarship.org/content/qt2p21911g/qt2p21911g.pdf?t=krrbo5>

** Glossary

** Appendix